Donné and I decided that the only thing to do was to get hold of the two credit-card slips and check out the signatures on both. We spoke to Mavericks' accountant on the phone, and she faxed us both slips. It was clear that the 02h30 tab's signature was mine. My handwriting is very distinct and I can be drunk out of my head, but I'll still sign it that way. The slip signed at 03h15 was another matter entirely, though. They said that I was so hammered that I could barely write, which was why the signature looked so odd.

'Ma'am,' I said – I was very polite – 'I've got a very unique signature. Have a look at it – that can't have been signed by my hand.'

I could only come up with one explanation: one of the dancers had taken my card during the lap dance, while my wallet was lying next to me, and she had swiped and signed it. They found out who the girl was, but they still insisted that I had signed the tab. There was no way they were going to pay me back the money.

We got my bank to send someone around to Mavericks to investigate the alleged fraud and the next step for us would have been to sue. However, Donné's advice was to let it go – she didn't think the money was worth the energy or the negative publicity. Wise counsel once again. We therefore decided to drop the matter. But the incident left a very bitter taste in my mouth.

It also wasn't over yet.

True to form – as you will have read, earlier actions of mine have a nasty habit of returning to bite me on the arse – a year and a half later I opened a daily newspaper to see a grainy picture of me enjoying that very lap dance. It turned out that Mavericks had fired one of its bouncers, and before the guy left, he'd helped himself to a whole lot of their CCTV footage. He then gave extracts of the footage to the newspapers as a way of getting back at his former employers. As I was a well-known public figure, he'd selected images of me, and my name was once again dragged through the mud. There's no doubt in my mind that the only reason Mavericks still had that footage was in case I decided to sue them. They would normally destroy CCTV footage after a shorter period of time.

What really angered me, though, was not that this guy had taken the footage and given it to the press, but that the paper had published it. I had just come out of rehab, and this kind of publicity was the last thing I needed. It was not as if it had happened recently – it had happened 18